RELOCATION TOOL · TERRY NABER & JAMES BARNES

How does Colorado Springs stack up?

Home values through 2026-09-30 (Zillow ZHVI, downloaded Nov 4, 2026). Property-tax rates are Census ACS 2020-2024. Cost of living is BEA 2024, released Feb 2026. Those files are not newer than that.

Austin, TX vs. Colorado Springs

A typical home in Austin is **$414,273**. The typical Colorado Springs home is **$446,711**, which is $32,438 more. Over the past year, Austin is down 4.3% and Colorado Springs is down 1.4%. Over five years, Austin is down 14.2% and Colorado Springs is up 3.8%.

On the illustration settings now on the page, the estimated monthly total is **$2,910** in Austin and **$2,713** in Colorado Springs, $197 lower in Colorado Springs. Principal and interest is $2,205 versus $2,378. Property tax is $532 versus $149 a month, because the effective rates are 1.54% and 0.40%.

Austin typical home	Colorado Springs typical home	Austin payment	Colorado Springs payment
$414,273	**$446,711**	**$2,910/mo**	**$2,713/mo**
1-year −4.3%	1-year −1.4%	Includes property tax	Includes property tax
5-year −14.2%	5-year +3.8%		

Monthly payment illustration

Do not double-count district taxes. Metropolitan district, school, city, and county mill levies are property tax. They are already inside each metro's effective tax rate, including Colorado Springs. The HOA / metro-district fee boxes are only for a separate monthly charge, such as HOA dues or a district operations fee that is not on the tax bill. Leave them at $0 unless you know there is one. Putting a mill levy here counts it twice.

About $197 less per month in Colorado Springs

Illustration on the settings above. Not a quote. Austin $2,910 · Colorado Springs $2,713.

	Austin, TX	Colorado Springs, CO
PRICE AND LOAN		
Typical home value	$414,273	$446,711
Down payment (20%)	$82,855	$89,342
Loan amount	$331,418	$357,369
Loan-to-value	80%	80%
MONTHLY LINES		
Principal and interest	$2,205 7% · 30-year illustration, not a quote	$2,378 7% · 30-year illustration, not a quote
Property tax	$532 $6,380/yr at 1.54%	$149 $1,787/yr at 0.40%
Homeowners insurance (assumption)	$173 Assumption · $2,071/yr at $5.00 per $1,000	$186 Assumption · $2,234/yr at $5.00 per $1,000
Mortgage insurance (assumption)	$0 Assumption · $0 because loan-to-value is not over 80%	$0 Assumption · $0 because loan-to-value is not over 80%
HOA or metro-district fee	$0 Optional · not property tax	$0 Optional · not property tax
Estimated monthly total	$2,910	$2,713

Illustration settings: 20% down, 7% interest, 30 years. Homeowners insurance assumption: $5.00 per $1,000 of value per year. Mortgage insurance assumption: 0.50% of the loan per year, only when loan-to-value is over 80%. HOA or metro-district fee: $0 per month in Austin and $0 per month in Colorado Springs. Not a quote.

Formulas. Principal and interest is fully amortizing. Monthly rate = annual rate ÷ 12. Payment = loan × monthly rate ÷ (1 − (1 + monthly rate) raised to the minus number of months). A zero rate uses loan ÷ number of months. This is an illustration, not a quote.

Property tax per year = home value × the metro effective rate. Per month = that ÷ 12. The rate is the Census median tax bill divided by the median home value, so city, school, and metropolitan-district mill levies are already in it.

Homeowners insurance is an assumption. Per year = home value ÷ 1,000 × the dollars-per-thousand figure. Per month = that ÷ 12. The same figure is used for both metros. It is not a quote.

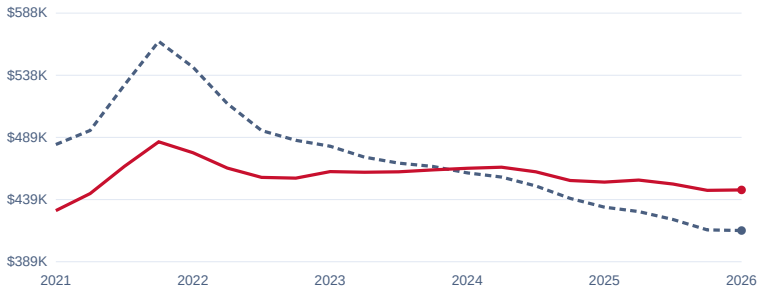
Mortgage insurance is an assumption for a conventional loan, not FHA or VA. Per month = loan × the annual MI percent ÷ 12, and only when the down payment is under 20% (loan-to-value over 80%). Otherwise the line is $0. It is not a quote.

Each line is rounded to the nearest dollar, then added, so the total matches the lines above.

Typical home and the trend

Zillow Home Value Index through 2026-09-30, downloaded Nov 4, 2026. Middle-third, smoothed, seasonally adjusted. The 1-year and 5-year changes are the figures stored with that file.

	Austin, TX	Colorado Springs, CO
Typical home value	$414,273	$446,711
1-year change	−4.3%	−1.4%
5-year change	−14.2%	+3.8%



Austin, TX Colorado Springs, CO Zillow ZHVI, quarterly, 2021-09 to 2026-09. Not a forecast.

Property tax

The effective rate is a metro average for owner-occupied homes: median real estate taxes paid divided by median home value (Census ACS 2020–2024). Annual tax on a price = that price × the rate. Monthly = annual ÷ 12. One row uses each metro's own typical home. The next uses one identical price, so you can see the rate instead of the price gap. District property taxes are in the rate. They are not an HOA fee.

	Austin, TX	Colorado Springs, CO
Effective property tax rate	1.54%	0.40%
Tax on the typical home, per year	$6,380	$1,787
Tax on the typical home, per month	$532	$149
Tax on a $446,711 home, per year	$6,879	$1,787
Tax on a $446,711 home, per month	$573	$149

Cost of living and buying power

A score of 100 is the U.S. average price level for a broad basket of goods and services. It is not a home-price index, and it is not your household budget. **Austin is 98.1**, 1.9% below the U.S. average of 100. **Colorado Springs is 100.7**, 0.7% above the U.S. average of 100.

On this measure, everyday prices in Colorado Springs run about 2.7% higher than in Austin. $100 of that basket in Austin costs about $102.69 in Colorado Springs. The other way, $100 of the basket in Colorado Springs costs about $97.38 in Austin.

What the typical home buys

Cash equal to a typical Austin home ($414,273), before selling costs and any mortgage you still owe, would cover 93% of a typical Colorado Springs home. That is about $32,438 short of $446,711.

Cash equal to a typical Colorado Springs home ($446,711), before selling costs and any mortgage you still owe, would cover a typical Austin home ($414,273) and leave about $32,438. That cash is 108% of a typical Austin home.

Housing buying power compares the two typical values only. It is not a sale proceeds estimate and it ignores commissions, repairs, and the loan payoff.

State income tax, in brief

Texas does not tax wages. Colorado taxes income at a flat rate. The worksheet Colorado publishes for 2026 wage withholding applies 4.40% of Colorado taxable income after the state adjustments. The rate has changed before, including a temporary reduction, and it can change again. Colorado cities and counties do not add a wage tax. This is a general note about the kind of tax, not a tax bill and not tax advice.

About the data

- **Typical home value and trend:** Zillow Home Value Index (ZHVI), all homes, middle third, smoothed and seasonally adjusted, by metro, through 2026-09-30 (zillow.com/research/data, downloaded Nov 4, 2026). The chart uses quarterly points from 2021-09 to 2026-09.
- **Effective property tax rate:** median real estate taxes paid divided by median home value for owner-occupied homes in the metro, U.S. Census Bureau ACS 2020-2024 5-year estimates (tables B25103 and B25077, via Census Reporter). A metro-wide average; individual bills vary by county, district and assessed value.
- **Cost of living:** U.S. Bureau of Economic Analysis Regional Price Parities, all items, 2024 (released Feb 2026). U.S. average = 100. BEA publishes this only for metropolitan areas, so smaller micropolitan areas show “not available”.
- Zillow metro names are matched to Census and BEA metros by principal city and state.
- **Not in those files:** the interest rate, homeowners insurance, mortgage insurance, and HOA or metro-district fee. Those are the assumptions in the payment section, with the formulas next to them. Insurance and mortgage insurance are adjustable assumptions, not quotes. The optional fee is not property tax.
- The files are not newer than the dates above. Nothing on this page is a live Zillow feed, a current tax bill, or a rate quote.
- Sample PDF, built from this page’s default illustration (20% down, 7.00% rate, 30 years, $5.00 insurance per $1,000 of value per year, 0.50% mortgage insurance only if loan-to-value is over 80%, HOA $0): austin-vs-colorado-springs.pdf.

Ready to make Colorado Springs home?

Terry will show you the neighborhoods. James will show you the numbers on a real loan.



Terry Naber
REALTOR®, RE/MAX Properties
(719) 491-8966 · terry.naber@wesellmore.net · buysellcoloradosprings.com

Call Terry | Text Terry | Email Terry



James Barnes
Senior Loan Officer, Nexa Lending · NMLS #215987
(512) 228-8124 · jbarnes@nexalending.com · BestLenderinColorado.com

Call James | Email James | Apply online

BestLenderinColorado.com

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Live tool: jbarnes1960.github.io/relocation-compare